

# Emily Drake

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## CAREER OBJECTIVE

Senior Technical Product Manager with 26 years in Product/Design, currently at Spotify. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Sketch, Jira and Confluence.

## EXPERIENCE

### Spotify — Senior Technical Product Manager

Mar 2008 – Present

- Partnered with data to define activation and retention definitions the whole company now uses.
- Negotiated scope with engineering and legal to ship a compliance deadline on time.
- Reduced support contacts by 12% by reworking the checkout and error states.
- Ran discovery interviews with 3 customers, reshaping the following year's roadmap.
- Shipped a design system in Figma adopted across 2 product surfaces.

### Technical Product Manager, Palantir

Nov 2001 – Oct 2007

- Prototyped 50 concepts in Figma and killed two early on evidence rather than opinion.
- Introduced accessibility standards to the design process, taking 2 flows to WCAG AA.
- Built the experimentation framework the team uses to size bets before committing.
- Redesigned onboarding in Figma, lifting activation from 10% to 90%.

### Technical Product Manager

Vantage Analytics | Jun 2000 – Jul 2001

- Facilitated usability testing that surfaced 50 critical friction points before launch.
- Prioritised a backlog for 3 engineers, delivering 4 releases per quarter.
- Wrote the PRDs and acceptance criteria for a platform migration affecting 5k users.

### Lumen Works — Product Manager

Oct 1999 – Apr 2000

- Defined north-star metrics and instrumented them across 6 delivery squads.
- Ran quarterly roadmap reviews with executive stakeholders and published the trade-offs openly.
- Standardised the team's tooling with Azure, ending long-running environment drift.

## EDUCATION

### PhD, Electrical Engineering

Oakmere University | 1995 – 1999

Thesis: "Low-power sensor networks for building monitoring"

### Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

Georgia Institute of Technology | 1991 – 1994

## SKILLS

Sketch (9 yrs), Jira (10 yrs), Confluence (1 year), Figma (15 yrs), React (20 yrs), SQL (22 yrs), Power BI (23 yrs), TypeScript (9 yrs), Excel (13 yrs), Looker (14 yrs), Tableau (11 yrs), Databricks (16 yrs), Linux (18 yrs), Spring Boot (6 yrs), Scikit-learn (6 yrs), Azure (24 yrs)

## PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — Cloud Native Computing Foundation, 2026

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2025

## PUBLICATIONS

"Signal denoising on embedded hardware" - co-authored conference paper, 2000.

**OUTSIDE OF WORK**

Woodworking, Sailing